

Evidence Axis

Passionfroot Evidence Appendix

Gift #15 | Public competitive evidence | Checked 3 Sep 2026

Scope. This appendix supports the Executive Brief. It tests two bounded questions: (1) whether native LinkedIn creator discovery changes the durability of Passionfroot's discovery-layer differentiation, and (2) how Passionfroot's expanding managed-execution layer overlaps with LinkedIn's BrandWorks services. It is not a full creator-marketing market map.

1. Claim legend

Label	Meaning
FACT	Directly supported by cited public evidence.
COMPANY SELF-REPORT	A company-authored operating or financial claim used with provenance; not treated as independently audited fact.
INFERENCE	Reasoned interpretation from verified facts. Not presented as a proven internal state.
NOT ESTABLISHED	Searched or considered, but not proven by the public evidence reviewed.

2. Final findings

Finding 1 - Native discovery is now a differentiation layer to re-test. FACT: LinkedIn launched Creator Marketplace in Campaign Manager on 10 Jun 2026, centralizing creator search, profile/audience/performance insight and contact access. FACT: Digiday says the product is an English-only alpha for select brands and creators in North America and records mixed expert views on whether discovery is the hard B2B problem. FACT: Passionfroot's current Zest documentation supports discovery of external creators not yet on Passionfroot, then outreach and campaign workflow. INFERENCE: creator access alone may be a less durable center of differentiation than the operating layer after discovery. GUARDRAIL: the actual launch date of Passionfroot external-creator support is not established, and no causal link to LinkedIn is claimed.

Finding 2 - Passionfroot is scaling a human execution layer that creates partial functional overlap with LinkedIn BrandWorks. FACT: Gamma reports using Passionfroot's Managed Plan with a dedicated campaign manager and full-service management in Q2 2025. FACT: current Amplify is fully managed end-to-end. FACT: current Passionfroot recruiting describes a 5-6 person Campaign Manager team and company-reported \$2M+/month creator spend across 6-8 accounts. FACT: LinkedIn says BrandWorks provides hands-on strategy and creative support; Reuters reports Top Voices 360 pairs advertisers with creators and generated more than \$20M revenue May 2025-May 2026. INFERENCE: part of the LinkedIn-specific managed job overlaps functionally. GUARDRAIL: same-account, same-budget competition is not established.

3. Source register

ID	Source	Class	Date / location	Use
S1	Passionfroot homepage	Company / primary	passionfroot.me; checked 3 Sep 2026	Current AI-agent-for-creator-led-GTM positioning; end-to-end workflow.
S2	Zest - Creator marketing AI Agent	Company help / primary	help.passionfroot.me; written 25 Jun 2026	Strategy, discovery, internal/external creators, outreach, collaboration, reporting; documentation-date caveat.
S3	LinkedIn - Creator Marketplace + BrandWorks launch	Platform / primary	news.linkedin.com; 10 Jun 2026	Creator Marketplace capabilities; Campaign Manager; BrandWorks scope and agency-partner boundary.
S4	Digiday - LinkedIn creator marketplace	Independent media	digiday.com; 10 Jun 2026	Alpha/North America/English-only; opposing expert views; directory-vs-engine guardrail.
S5	TechCrunch - Passionfroot Series A	Independent media + direct founder attribution	techcrunch.com; 22 Jul 2026	\$15M Series A; NY/Sao Paulo expansion; 15-person headcount; founder-reported 13x revenue and customers.
S6	Passionfroot Amplify	Company / primary	passionfroot.me/amplify; checked 3 Sep 2026	Fully managed end-to-end; strategy, creator network, managed execution, measurement; tech-company focus.

Source register continues on the next page.

3. Source register - continued

ID	Source	Class	Date / location	Use
S7	Gamma partner story	Company case study	passionfroot.me; current; Q2 2025 results	Managed Plan; dedicated campaign manager; full-service management; Q2 2025 chronology; reported campaign run entirely on LinkedIn.
S8	Head of Client Deployment	Company recruiting / primary	jobs.ashbyhq.com; checked 3 Sep 2026	5-6 Campaign Managers; \$2M+/mo across 6-8 accounts; agency-background role; 13x/profitable as company self-report.
S9	Reuters - LinkedIn BrandWorks	Independent media	reuters.com; 10 Jun 2026	BrandWorks customer range; Top Voices 360; >\$20M May 2025-May 2026; SAP/IBM/ServiceNow.
S10	Founding GTM	Company recruiting / primary	jobs.ashbyhq.com; checked 3 Sep 2026	Company claim that AI agents are 10x-ing execution; no-sales-team / revenue statements treated as self-report.
S11	Founding Marketer	Company recruiting / primary	jobs.ashbyhq.com; checked 3 Sep 2026	Marketing function being built from ground up; product-marketing/positioning ownership not yet institutionalized.
S12	HubSpot partner story	Company case study	passionfroot.me; checked 3 Sep 2026	Enterprise-scale buyer signal (5,000-10,000 employees); DOES NOT establish Managed Plan/Amplify use.

SOURCE HYGIENE

S8 and S10 contain operating/financial claims authored by Passionfroot. Those claims are labeled COMPANY SELF-REPORT in the claim map. S12 is deliberately not used as managed-execution evidence.

4. Claim map

ID	Status	Allowed claim	Evidence
C01	FACT	LinkedIn launched Creator Marketplace on 10 Jun 2026 inside Campaign Manager.	S3-S4
C02	FACT	Marketplace supports search by topic/expertise, audience/performance assessment and creator contact access.	S3-S4
C03	FACT	Digiday reports alpha access for select brands/creators in North America and English-only content.	S4
C04	FACT	Independent expert reaction is divided on whether native discovery solves the hard B2B creator problem.	S4
C05	FACT	Zest can reach creators already on Passionfroot and external creators not yet on the platform.	S2
C06	FACT	Zest extends beyond discovery into strategy, outreach, collaboration and reporting.	S1-S2
C07	INFERENCE	Creator access alone may be a less durable differentiation layer as native platform discovery improves.	S2-S4
C08	NOT ESTABLISHED	LinkedIn has commoditized B2B creator discovery. DO NOT CLAIM.	-

Claim map continues on the next page.

4. Claim map - continued

ID	Status	Allowed claim	Evidence
C09	NOT ESTABLISHED	External Creator support launched on 25 Jun 2026. The Help Center date is documentation timing, not feature-launch proof.	S2
C10	NOT ESTABLISHED	Passionfroot added external creators because of LinkedIn. DO NOT CLAIM.	-
C11	FACT	Gamma says it used Managed Plan with a dedicated campaign manager and full-service campaign management.	S7
C12	FACT	Gamma reports Q2 2025 results, establishing managed execution before the Jun 2026 LinkedIn launches.	S7
C13	FACT	Amplify is described as fully managed end-to-end, including strategy, outreach, coordination and payments.	S6
C14	COMPANY SELF-REPORT	Current Client Deployment role says 5-6 Campaign Managers oversee \$2M+/mo across 6-8 accounts.	S8
C15	COMPANY SELF-REPORT	Passionfroot job posts say the company is growing 13x YoY and is profitable.	S8,S10
C16	FACT	LinkedIn says BrandWorks provides hands-on strategy/creative support and works with brands and agency partners.	S3

Claim map continues on the next page.

4. Claim map - continued

ID	Status	Allowed claim	Evidence
C17	FACT	Reuters reports Top Voices 360 pairs advertisers with creators and generated >\$20M revenue from May 2025-May 2026.	S9
C18	FACT	Reuters names BrandWorks customers ranging from SAP to Webflow; Top Voices 360 clients include SAP, IBM and ServiceNow.	S9
C19	INFERENCE	Part of Passionfroot managed execution overlaps functionally with LinkedIn-owned services on LinkedIn-specific programs.	S3,S6-S9
C20	NOT ESTABLISHED	Passionfroot and BrandWorks compete for the same accounts, budgets or procurement decisions. DO NOT CLAIM.	-
C21	FACT	HubSpot case lists 5,000-10,000 employees and describes platform usage across discovery-to-reporting workflow.	S12
C22	NOT ESTABLISHED	HubSpot used Managed Plan or Amplify. DO NOT CLAIM.	S12
C23	COMPANY SELF-REPORT	Founding GTM says Passionfroot AI agents are 10x-ing how creator marketing gets executed.	S10
C24	FACT	Founding Marketer role says the marketing function is being built from the ground up and nobody owns the Passionfroot story yet.	S11

5. Finding 1 evidence - native discovery

Evidence point	Status	Source
Creator Marketplace is inside LinkedIn Campaign Manager.	FACT	S3-S4
Marketers can search creators, inspect audience/performance and access contact information.	FACT	S3-S4
The product is an alpha for select North American brands/creators and English-only.	FACT	S4
LinkedIn ties creator discovery to Thought Leader Ads / paid amplification.	FACT	S3
Zest discovers creators and continues into outreach, collaboration and reporting.	FACT	S1-S2
Zest can reach external creators not yet on Passionfroot.	FACT	S2
Creator access alone may be a less durable differentiation center.	INFERENCE	S2-S4

GUARDRAIL

Digiday records both a pro-marketplace view and a skeptical view. The evidence supports a re-test of discovery as differentiation, not a declaration that discovery is solved or commoditized.

Timing lock

Date	Observed public state	EA read
10 Jun 2026	LinkedIn launches Creator Marketplace and BrandWorks.	Native LinkedIn discovery becomes public.
25 Jun 2026	Passionfroot Help Center page documents Zest support for internal and external creators.	Documentation date only; actual feature launch date is unknown.
22 Jul 2026	TechCrunch reports Series A and U.S. expansion.	Decision exposure is current, but no causal chain between these events is inferred.

6. Finding 1 - contradiction and wording lock

Attack	Result
Could LinkedIn be dismissed as a full-stack mismatch?	PARTIAL. It does not match Passionfroot end to end, but it now covers a real LinkedIn-specific discovery/contact layer inside Campaign Manager.
Does independent evidence say the marketplace will work?	NO CONSENSUS. Digiday presents opposing views and says it remains to be seen whether this becomes a partnership engine or mainly a better directory.
Can we claim Passionfroot opened its marketplace boundary at the same time?	NO. The June 25 Help Center date does not establish the feature launch date.
Can we claim Passionfroot reacted to LinkedIn?	NO. No reviewed source establishes causality.
Does the decision question still survive?	YES. The public overlap is enough to test whether discovery or post-discovery orchestration should anchor U.S. positioning.

WORDING LOCK - ALLOWED

LinkedIn has begun internalizing LinkedIn-specific B2B creator discovery inside Campaign Manager. Passionfroot's current workflow reaches beyond discovery and beyond creators already on its platform. That combination makes discovery a differentiation layer worth re-testing.

WORDING LOCK - AVOID

Do not write: 'LinkedIn is replacing Passionfroot,' 'discovery is commoditized,' 'Passionfroot responded by opening its marketplace,' or any version of 'just as' that implies the launch timing of External Creator support is known.

7. Finding 2 evidence - managed execution

Evidence point	Status	Source
Gamma says it used Managed Plan with a dedicated campaign manager, custom strategy and full-service campaign management.	FACT	S7
Gamma reports Q2 2025 results.	FACT	S7
The reported Gamma campaign results were run entirely on LinkedIn, despite the broader case-study platform strip.	FACT	S7
Amplify is fully managed end-to-end and includes managed outreach, briefing, coordination and payments.	FACT	S6
Amplify says it works with a select number of tech companies.	FACT	S6
Client Deployment recruiting describes a current team of 5-6 Campaign Managers.	COMPANY SELF-REPORT	S8
\$2M+/month in creator spend across 6-8 accounts.	COMPANY SELF-REPORT	S8
13x YoY revenue growth and profitable.	COMPANY SELF-REPORT	S8,S10

Chronology

Period	Public evidence	What it rules out
Q2 2025	Gamma Managed Plan with full-service campaign management.	Managed execution did not originate as a reaction to the Jun 2026 LinkedIn launches.
Jun 2026	LinkedIn publicly launches BrandWorks; Reuters says it had been launched internally in March.	LinkedIn is building a services layer around B2B campaigns.
Current	Amplify + Client Deployment hiring make Passionfroot managed execution more explicit and operationalized.	The service layer cannot be treated as incidental platform support.

8. Finding 2 - overlap boundary

Dimension	Passionfroot	LinkedIn / BrandWorks	Evidence read
Core managed job	Creator strategy, creator selection, outreach, briefing, coordination, payments, measurement.	Brand/creative/content/events strategy and support for LinkedIn campaigns; Top Voices 360 pairs advertisers with creators.	PARTIAL FUNCTIONAL OVERLAP.
Channel boundary	Broader creator-led GTM workflow; Amplify examples are tech-company launches.	All built for LinkedIn.	NOT FULL-STACK EQUIVALENCE.
Buyer range	Tech-focused Amplify; platform also has enterprise-scale HubSpot case.	Reuters names SAP-Webflow range; Top Voices 360 includes SAP, IBM, ServiceNow.	CLEAN SEGMENT SEPARATION NOT ESTABLISHED.
Procurement / account overlap	Not public.	Not public.	SAME ACCOUNT / SAME BUDGET COMPETITION NOT ESTABLISHED.
Human vs AI boundary	Zest plus a 5-6 person Campaign Manager team and senior deployment role.	Human expert service plus platform ad/creator infrastructure.	PASSIONFROOT HAS AN INTERNAL PRODUCT/SERVICE BOUNDARY TO DEFINE.

DECISION INTERPRETATION

The more defensible finding is not 'BrandWorks is Passionfroot's new direct competitor.' It is that Passionfroot's managed layer has expanded far enough that a platform-owned LinkedIn service now overlaps with part of the job. That raises a product/service design question inside Passionfroot even if account-level competition never materializes.

9. Dropped and constrained claims

Claim considered	Final status	Why
Naano is a core Passionfroot competitor / U.S. wedge threat.	DROPPED	Vendor-authored comparison itself frames the tools as potentially complementary, and the required independent competitive-set proof was not established.
LinkedIn is a full-stack Passionfroot replacement.	NOT ALLOWED	Creator Marketplace is a bounded discovery/contact layer; BrandWorks is LinkedIn-native. Passionfroot covers a broader operating workflow.
External Creator support launched 25 Jun 2026.	NOT ESTABLISHED	That is the Help Center documentation date, not a proven feature-launch date.
Passionfroot launched Amplify because of LinkedIn.	NOT ESTABLISHED	Managed Plan evidence predates the LinkedIn launches and no causal source was found.
HubSpot proves enterprise use of Managed Plan.	NOT ESTABLISHED	HubSpot case proves enterprise-scale platform use, not Managed Plan / Amplify.
BrandWorks is only for mega-enterprise buyers.	NOT ESTABLISHED	Reuters names customers ranging from SAP to Webflow.
Passionfroot and BrandWorks are fighting for the same budgets.	NOT ESTABLISHED	No public account, budget or procurement evidence establishes this.

10. QA notes and final wording locks

Adversarial changes that materially altered the brief

- Naano was removed from the core competitive set after the vendor comparison failed the independent membership standard.
- LinkedIn was narrowed from a possible full-stack threat to a bounded native-discovery and managed-service overlap.
- The phrase "just as Passionfroot is opening the boundary" was removed because the Help Center publication date does not establish the feature launch date.
- HubSpot was removed from managed-tier proof and retained only as an enterprise-scale buyer signal.
- The 13x growth, profitable and deployment-spend numbers are labeled company self-report.
- The Founding GTM "10x-ing execution" statement was directly checked on the live Ashby job page and remains a company claim, not independent performance proof.

Final safe language

FINDING 01

LinkedIn has begun internalizing LinkedIn-specific creator discovery inside Campaign Manager. Passionfroot's current product extends from discovery into a broader creator operating workflow and can reach external creators. This makes discovery a differentiation layer to re-test; it does not prove that discovery is commoditized.

FINDING 02

Passionfroot has had managed execution since at least Q2 2025 and is now scaling it more explicitly. LinkedIn BrandWorks and Top Voices 360 overlap with part of that job on LinkedIn-specific programs. The overlap is functional and partial; direct same-account competition is not established.

Method boundary

Public evidence can establish market moves, product surfaces, hiring structure and company-stated operating signals. It cannot establish Passionfroot's internal roadmap intent, margins, win/loss causes, account-level competition, procurement behavior or which delivery tasks are profitable. Those remain the paid decision frontier.